What are cells?

All living things are made up of tiny parcels of matter called **cells**. Cells are the smallest units of living things. This is why they are sometimes called the **building blocks** of life.

Living things may be made up of just one cell or many billions of cells. Anything that is made up of one or more cells is considered a form of life or **lifeform**.

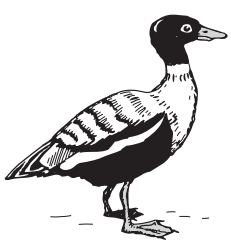
The bodies of all types of animals, including humans, are made up of cells. Different types of cells have different **functions** or jobs. Human bodies are made up of hundreds of different types of cells, including types of blood cells, nerve cells and skin cells.

All types of plants are made up of cells, too. Plant cells and animal cells have some similar parts and some different parts.

☞ **1** Which of these things are living things? Circle your choices.



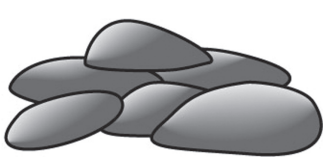
a) cake



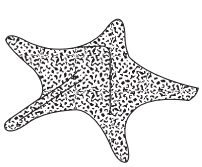
b) duck



c) fern



d) pile of stones



e) sea star

2 Which of the things in Question 1 are made up of cells?

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3 Circle the correct phrase within the brackets to complete each sentence.

a) Cells are (tiny parcels of matter / the enemies of all living things / found only in human bodies). They are sometimes called the (playdough / building blocks / organisms) of life.

b) Different types of cells have (different coloured parts / the same purpose / different functions or jobs).

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What are cells? CONT'D

4 Name three or more types of cells found in the human body.

_____

_____

_____

When scientists talk about a living thing, they use the word **organism**. When they talk about things related to cells, they use the word **cellular**.

5 Write the words in the box into the answer spaces to break them into syllables. Remember, each syllable makes one beat when you say the word aloud. For example, the word *matter* has two syllables: m a t / t e r.

living	organism	cellular	units

a) __ __ __ / __ __ __

b) __ __ / __ __ __ / __ __ / __

c) __ __ __ __ / __ / __ __ __

d) __ / __ __ __ __

6 If 'multi-' means many and 'uni-' means one, complete these sentences using the words from the word bank.

a) A _____ thing made up of _____ _____ is called a multicellular organism.

b) A living thing made up of _____ _____ is called a unicellular _____.

Word bank

organism

cells

one

living

cell

many

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